

Implement Threat Intelligence Principles

Non-SOC pathway: IOC analysis + connector recommendation for a banking-focused DeRexi deployment

WHAT THE REDUCED NON-SOC REQUIREMENT MEANS

For students not pursuing a SOC-focused role, the instructor allowed the OpenCTI deployment portion to be replaced with a documented recommendation. Instead of installing and demonstrating OpenCTI, this report identifies two appropriate connectors, explains why each matters to DeRexi, and documents the benefits they would provide. The two-IOC analysis requirement still applies.

1. Assignment requirements - DeRexi version

Requirement	How this report satisfies it
Analyze 2 Indicators of Compromise (IOCs)	Document the indicator, detection method, and how it relates to a real threat.
Recommend 2 OpenCTI connectors	Choose connectors that fit the project/industry and explain why each is important.
Explain operational value	Describe how the intelligence would help DeRexi identify, understand, or respond to threats.
Document clearly	Tie the work back to DeRexi's banking/financial-services use case.

2. IOC analysis

Indicator	IOC 1 - SHA-256 file hash
Value	02aac4d201886e01abd2e3d42a20edcb4e6c2381549de19df0b9166607cd3f51
Detection method	EDR/antivirus hash matching; SIEM searches across endpoint telemetry; threat-intelligence lookup against MalwareBazaar/VirusTotal.
Threat relevance	This hash identifies the malicious Linux shell-script dropper analyzed in the earlier malware dossier. A match on a DeRexi host would indicate that the known malicious sample, or an identical copy, is present.

Indicator	IOC 2 - Download infrastructure
Value	http://160.119.69.4/x IP: 160.119.69.4
Detection method	Proxy, DNS, firewall and IDS/IPS logs; URL/IP blocklists; alerting on outbound connections to the indicator.
Threat relevance	The malware dossier associates this infrastructure with retrieval of malicious content. A DeRexi endpoint contacting it could indicate payload staging or an active compromise.

WHY THESE TWO IOCS WORK WELL TOGETHER

The hash identifies the malicious file itself, while the URL/IP identifies network infrastructure associated with payload delivery. Together they show both endpoint-based and network-based detection methods.

Threat Intelligence Connector Strategy

Two OpenCTI connector recommendations aligned to DeRexi's financial-services threat model

3. Recommended OpenCTI connector #1 - abuse.ch

Recommended source: abuse.ch threat-intelligence feeds, especially MalwareBazaar / ThreatFox-style indicator data.

- Why it fits DeRexi: DeRexi is being designed for banking and financial-services organizations, where fast identification of malicious files, URLs, IP addresses and related infrastructure is valuable.
- Why it fits this coursework: the earlier malware analysis already used MalwareBazaar intelligence to investigate the k.php sample and its associated indicators.
- Operational benefit: imported indicators could be correlated with endpoint, proxy, DNS, firewall or SIEM telemetry so analysts can quickly see whether known malicious infrastructure is touching the DeRexi environment.
- Business benefit: faster recognition of known threats supports incident escalation, evidence preservation and protection of systems that store or deliver sensitive policy information.

4. Recommended OpenCTI connector #2 - MITRE ATT&CK

- Why it fits DeRexi: raw indicators tell defenders what to look for, but ATT&CK adds behavioral context - how an adversary gains access, executes commands, persists, discovers systems, collects data and evades detection.
- Why it fits this coursework: the APT38 / BeagleBoyz FASTCash case was already mapped to MITRE ATT&CK for the banking sector.
- Operational benefit: ATT&CK data helps connect observables and incidents to adversary tactics and techniques, making threat intelligence easier to communicate and prioritize.
- Business benefit: DeRexi can use that context to strengthen procedures for phishing reporting, privileged access, incident escalation, evidence handling and protection of financial-industry clients.

5. How the two connectors complement each other

Question	abuse.ch	MITRE ATT&CK
What does it mainly provide?	Concrete indicators and malware/infrastructure intelligence	Threat actors, tactics, techniques and behavioral context
What can DeRexi do with it?	Detect or investigate known hashes, URLs and IPs	Understand how observed activity fits an attack pattern
Why use both?	Shows WHAT is suspicious	Explains HOW and WHY the threat behaves

6. Analyst conclusion

For DeRexi, threat intelligence should combine specific indicators with behavioral context. The selected file hash and malicious download infrastructure provide practical detection targets, while abuse.ch and MITRE ATT&CK would give the organization two complementary intelligence streams: one focused on current indicators and one focused on adversary behavior. This approach is appropriate for the non-SOC pathway because it demonstrates how OpenCTI would be used without requiring platform deployment.

ASSIGNMENT CRITERIA CHECK

2 IOCs analyzed with detection methods and threat relevance ✓ | 2 OpenCTI connectors recommended ✓ | Connector importance and benefits explained ✓ | DeRexi / banking context documented ✓

SOURCE BASIS IOC values and malware context reuse the earlier Malware Analysis Threat Dossier. The ATT&CK connector rationale reuses the APT38 / BeagleBoyz FASTCash banking-sector mapping.